

XingTu + Amulet

Filled Validation Questionnaire

Known Answers & Actionables

Based on The Founder's Playbook (Anthropic, May 2026)

Sources compiled: pitch-package, user-portraits, viral-strategy, leads-strategy,
competitive-analysis, xingtu-ai/app, bazi-research prototypes, session history

Stage: Idea to MVP transition | Status: pre-validation | Date: June 20, 2026

CRITICAL: Zero customer discovery interviews. Amulet model unvalidated.

All answers below are from existing docs — NOT from real user conversations.

PART 1

Is the problem real?

1.1 Who exactly has this problem?

Who needs a Chinese name? (age, gender, country)

[V] DONE

5 documented personas. Sarah 28 LA (Western seeker), Wei 31 SG (diaspora), Li Wei 34 SH (Chinese), + B2B personas (HR, Dating).

Who wants daily BaZi fortune?

[] NEED DATA

Assumed overlap with name gen users. NOT validated through interviews. Inferred from persona analysis only.

Which segments will PAY?

[!] UNVALIDATED

B2C: Pro \$7 / Ultra \$19 one-time. B2B: API \$0.10, white-label \$200/mo. Fin model built for \$30k seed to \$229k Year 1. Zero validation.

1.2 How real is the problem?

Monthly search volume?

[] ACTIONABLE

NOT checked. Need: Google Keyword Planner for 'Chinese name generator', 'BaZi fortune', 'ZWDS calculator', 'Chinese astrology app'.

Existing solutions?

[V] DONE

11 competitors analyzed. 4 categories: chart calculators, Chinese apps, Western esoteric, BaZi-only. Gap: English ZWDS with AI = emp

Why users DISSatisfied?

[] ACTIONABLE

Persona research: literal translations (Greedy Wolf) confuse, no narrative, cultural barrier. App store reviews NOT scraped — would val

Key stat from competitive analysis: English ZWDS Shorts = 32-520 views. Chinese ZWDS Shorts = 42K-92K views. 100-2000x gap = untapped English demand.

1.3 What do users do NOW?

Behavior	Evidence	Status
Free online generators	ziweicharts, wenming, alipay — all free, cluttered	[V] Known
Offline BaZi masters	\$50-150 SGD per session. Slow, expensive	[V] Known
Ignore the need	English users never encounter ZWDS. Mark	[V] Known
Western astrology apps	Co-Star 20M users, The Pattern 10M. Paid	[V] Known

1.4 Amulet hypothesis

Demand for Chinese amulets online?

[] ACTIONABLE

NOT researched. Need: Etsy amulet sales, Taoist talisman shops, Alibaba Feng Shui trends.

Who is amulet buyer?

[?] UNKNOWN

HYPOTHESIS: same user who gets Chinese name. But may be different (collector vs name-seeker). Not validated.

Willingness to pay for blessed name amulet?

[?] NEED DATA

Hyp: \$15-30. Based on Etsy custom talisman \$12-35 range. NO market test done.

AMULET IS THE BIGGEST UNKNOWN. Entire monetization model depends on it — zero research done.

PART 2

Is the solution right?

2.1 Feature parity

Feature	XingTu	Competitors	Gap
Name gen EN>CN	v6 prototype, 75 names	?	Need 200+
BaZi prediction	Engine ready (pillars, elements,	Raw chart dumps	Better UX [V]
Amulet tied to name	Not started	?	MVP BLOCKER
Behavior tracker	Not started	?	MVP BLOCKER
Works offline	Flutter, local engine	Most need internet	Advantage [V]
Monetization	Not implemented	Free or one-time	Needs Stripe

2.2 Three critical assumptions

ASSUMPTION 1: Users buy amulet based on their generated name

If false: only ad-revenue. \$5-15 CPM x 150k MAU = \$500-1500/mo. Not enough.

Test: mock amulet page. If <5% click 'view amulet', pivot monetization.

ASSUMPTION 2: Free generator -> traffic -> conversion

If false: only paid acquisition. TG Stories CPA \$2-5. \$30k = 6-15k paid users.

Viral content strategy fully built (12 themes, week-1 calendar, 4 segments).

ASSUMPTION 3: BaZi creates retention

If false: one-shot user, zero LTV. Current prototype is single-use (enter DOB, get chart, done).

Need daily BaZi push (TG bot) in MVP scope. Without it, no retention mechanic.

2.3 Critical pivot insight

Original project was ZWDS AI (LLM-dependent, \$0.03/chart cost, complex). Pivot to Name Generator + BaZi (local engine, zero API cost). This FUNDAMENTALLY changes unit economics. Old financial model (\$229k Year 1, 99.5% margin) is OUTDATED. Needs rebuild for amulet model with COGS.

PART 3

Enough signal to build?

3.1 What we HAVE (15 assets)

HTML prototype v6 (Wheel of Fate + BaZi chart)	[V] Ready
Flutter app (Android + Web) — build passes	[V] Ready
BaZi engine (pillars, elements, animals, luck cycles)	[V] Ready
Name generator DB (75 EN>CN + 20 CN>EN)	[] Missing
Pitch package (exec sum, fin model, risks, deck outline)	[V] Ready
User portraits (5 detailed personas)	[V] Ready
Viral strategy (12 themes, week-1 calendar, 4 segments)	[V] Ready
Content plan (TikTok/YouTube/Shorts platform-specific)	[V] Ready
Lead gen strategy (7 channels, CPA estimates, templates)	[V] Ready
Competitive analysis (11 competitors, 6 gaps)	[V] Ready
Financial model (but outdated — built for ZWDS AI)	[] Missing
Amulet e-commerce flow	[] Missing
Behavior tracker / analytics	[] Missing
Customer discovery interviews (0)	[] Missing
Scope definition / CLAUDE.md / ADR	[] Missing

3.2 Idea Stage Exit Check (from playbook)

Problem is real? (Chinese names, BaZi — demand exists)	[V] Confirmed
We know EXACT user? (name, gender, country, behavior)	[] Unknown
Solution addresses the real problem (not assumed one)?	[] Unknown
Enough signal for building commitment?	[] Unknown

MAIN GAP: Zero customer discovery. No confirmation the problem is real for specific people.

3.3 What the old financial model assumed

Old model (for ZWDS AI): \$30k seed -> \$229k Year 1 revenue, 99.5% margin, break-even Month 4. Based on LLM SaaS, not amulet sales.

New reality: Name Gen + BaZi + Amulet. Zero engine cost (good). But COGS (bad): amulet production \$5-10 + Stripe fees 2.9%+\$0.30 + shipping. Margins TBD.

VERDICT: Old fin model is irrelevant. Must rebuild for amulet model after supplier research.

PART 4

What to build first (MVP scope)

4.1 MVP v1.0 — Must have (priority order)

#	Feature	Status	Effort	Depends on
1	Name gen EN>CN + CN>	Prototype exists	3-5 days	Expand DB to 200+
2	BaZi fortune chart	Engine exists	2-3 days	Integrate into Flutter
3	Wheel of Fate animation	Done (v6 HTML)	1 day	Port to Flutter
4	Amulet flow (catalog>cart)	Not started	5-8 days	Supplier + Stripe
5	Behavior tracker (events,	Not started	2-3 days	PostHog setup
6	Multi-language (EN/RU/ZH)	Basic skeleton	3-5 days	Add ZH content
7	Share image (viral card)	Strategy designed	2-3 days	Flutter canvas

Total MVP effort: 18-28 days solo dev.

4.2 NOT in MVP (scope boundary)

- ☐ Login wall
- ☐ Prediction history
- ☐ AI interpretation
- ☐ Social feed

4.3 What's MISSING before launch

Security review	☐ Run Claude Code security scan. 1 day.
Privacy policy	☐ Generate from template. 2 hours.
Stripe / payment integration	☐ Need legal entity. ALT: Telegram Stars.
Analytics (PostHog)	☐ Free tier. 1 day. Do NOW.
Amulet supplier	☐ Research Alibaba/Etsy. CRITICAL PATH.
Pre-launch landing page	☐ Email capture. Only if content test works.
Beta testers (5-10)	☐ Recruit from TG groups. Can start TODAY.
CLAUDE.md / ADR	☐ Write during build.

GATE: Payment needs legal entity. Without it -> no Stripe. ALT: Telegram Stars (no legal entity, capped \$50k/yr). Research TG Stars.

PART 5

Amulet monetization funnel

5.1 Conversion funnel (ALL hypothetical)

Visit	100%
Generate name	60% (hyp)
View amulet	10% (hyp)
Add to cart	? (no data)
Payment	2-5% (hyp)
Delivery	\$5-10 cost

5.2 Business model — known vs unknown

Parameter	Known / Hypothesis	Status
Traffic source	Content viral loop (TikTok, Reddit, TG)	[V] Strategy ready
Traffic CPM	\$5-15 (TG Stories)	[!] Estimated only
Name gen conversion	60% (hypothesis)	[!] Needs data
Amulet view conversion	10% (hypothesis)	[!] Needs data
Purchase conversion	2-5% (hypothesis)	[!] Needs data
Avg amulet price	\$15-30 (hypothesis)	[!] Needs research
Cost per amulet	\$5-10 (hypothesis)	[] Depends on supplier
Old fin model	\$229k Y1, 99.5% margin	[] OUTDATED
New model needed	Amulet COGS + fees + shipping	[] URGENT

ROUGH BACK-OF-ENVELOPE (if amulet margin = \$10):

- 10,000 name gens -> 300 amulets -> \$3,000 revenue -> \$1,500 margin
- 100,000 name gens -> 3,000 amulets -> \$30,000 revenue -> \$15,000 margin
- Target 3,000 amulets/mo = \$15k margin = break-even on \$30k seed in 4-6 months

5.3 What the tracker must measure

Name generated [P0]

Get Amulet clicked [P0]

Amulet detail viewed [P0]

Add to cart [P0]

Checkout started [P0]

Payment completed [P0]

Day 1 return [P1]

Day 7 return [P1]

Day 30 return [P1]

Share card generated [P1]

Second prediction [P1]

ACTIONABLE: Set up PostHog NOW. Free tier. 1-2 hours. Instrument HTML prototype even before app live.

PART 6

Roadmap with gates

Phase 1 — Hypothesis validation (1-2 weeks)

Start content test: 1 TikTok/Shorts/day x 14 days	[] Not started
Recruit 5-10 beta testers from TG diaspora groups	[] Not started
Conduct 5-10 discovery interviews	[] Not started
Keyword research: search volumes	[] ACTIONABLE
Mine app store reviews of competitors	[] ACTIONABLE
Research amulet suppliers (Alibaba/Etsy)	[] ACTIONABLE
Rebuild financial model for amulet model	[] ACTIONABLE

Phase 2 — MVP Scope + Build (2-3 weeks)

Write MVP scope document	Depends on Phase 1
Build amulet flow (catalog > cart > Stripe)	Legal entity needed (or TG Stars)
Implement behavior tracker (PostHog)	Can start NOW
Expand name DB to 200+	1-2 days work
Add daily BaZi fortune push (TG bot)	Retention foundation
Port v6 prototype to Flutter	3-5 days
Security scan before deploy	Claude Code Security

Phase 3 — Beta Launch (1 week)

5-10 beta testers from Phase 1	Phase 1 recruitment
MVP deployed to TestFlight / APK	Phase 2 build
Measurement dashboard live	Phase 2 tracker
Feedback loop: weekly synthesis	Beta engagement

Phase 4 — Full Launch (2-4w after PMF)

Android APK to Play Store	PMF evidence from Phase 3
Web to custom domain	Phase 3 iteration
Content marketing push	Phase 1 content test results
Paid acquisition test (TG Stories)	Conversion data from Phase 3
Amulet production + logistics	Phase 1 supplier research

PART

Summary + Decision tree

Current status: Idea Stage (incomplete)

Decision tree from HERE:

START: Run Phase 1 (content test + interviews + supplier)

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+-- Interviews show NO interest in name gen + BaZi

| +-- PIVOT: test amulet-only, or abandon?

|

+-- Amulet COGS too high / no supplier

| +-- PIVOT: subscription model (daily fortune \$3/mo)

|

+-- Content test shows zero engagement

| +-- PIVOT: paid acquisition test with \$500

|

+-- Phase 1 confirms -> Proceed to Phase 2

|

+-- Legal entity for Stripe (or use TG Stars)

+-- Build MVP -> Beta -> Launch

What you can do THIS WEEK (right now, no dependencies, free)

1. Start PostHog — free cloud, 1-2 hours setup. Even without app.
2. Post 1 TikTok on 'weird English names + Chinese astrology' — test hook \$0.
3. Join 3 TG diaspora groups — introduce yourself, offer free name checks.
4. Email 3 Etsy amulet sellers — ask about custom name talisman pricing.
5. Google 'Chinese name generator' + 'BaZi' — see real competition + keywords.

Source: The Founder's Playbook — Building an AI-Native Startup (Anthropic, May 2026)

All answers compiled from xingtu-ai/, bazi-research/, session history. Missing data flagged as [] or [!].